



HARVESTING

When the “head” of the cabbage feels solid and well-developed, cut it off, leaving a 1 in (2.5 cm) stump left in the ground. Within the next few weeks this will resprout and provide a second crop. Young, late-sown plants can be harvested as cut-and-come-again crops when they are a couple of weeks old. Bolted leaves are also edible.

STORING

Cabbage heads can be stored in the refrigerator for several weeks, but are best eaten fresh, so harvest them just before use.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Chinese cabbage, as with all brassicas, is susceptible to clubroot and cabbage root fly (see pp.246–7). Place a brassica collar around seedlings to deter pests, and plant seeds where you have grown peas, beans, or fruiting vegetables the previous season.



Make a collar from a square of carpet.